Alaa El Banna

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Digital product designer and former business founder with a Master of Digital Media (Product Design and AI) from Toronto Metropolitan University. Over two years designing AI enabled products alongside developers and product managers, and seven years running a client facing B2B and B2C business with 100+ accounts. Skilled at researching user and business problems, structuring findings into clear recommendations, and using AI tools to move from insight to solution faster.

EDUCATION

Master of Digital Media (Product Design & AI)
Toronto Metropolitan University

- *GPA:* 4.22 / 4.3
- *Relevant Coursework:* Interaction Design · UX & UI Design · Creative AI & Experiential Design · Digital Media Entrepreneurship · Digital Fabrication

Bachelor of Arts, Interior Design

- Notre Dame University – Louaize

EXPERIENCE

Product Designer
Monstrum (Apprenticeship) *March 2026—Oct 2026*

- Led design for a project focused on improving content visibility across SEO, AEO, and GEO channels.
- Designed the workflow for AI generated content briefs, translating keyword, audience, and intent inputs into clear, structured direction for the AI agents to act on.
- Applied information hierarchy and data visualization principles to design the performance dashboard, helping users interpret rankings and content metrics at a glance and prioritize their next action.
- Built a design memory workflow, translating the design system into structured Design MD files fed into Claude, so new draft screens could be generated consistently without rebuilding context each time. Designed all high fidelity screens by hand in Figma.
- Partnered with product management to align design decisions with business priorities and user needs across the platform.

Product Designer
NEOMERS *Aug 2024—Apr 2026, Contract · Remote*

- Built a mobile first design system from scratch in Figma, including a 6 step typography scale and a library of 20+ reusable components (buttons, cards, forms, navigation) utilizing variables for color and spacing.
- Documented design systems across 3+ projects in Design MD files fed into Claude, speeding up early-stage wireframing while keeping specs aligned across the team.
- Created variant instances of key components to gather feedback from developers, speeding up design decisions before handoff.
- Iterated on accessibility based on developer feedback, redesigning the colour system and typography to meet WCAG 2.2 AA contrast standards across the product suite.
- Designed with a focus on improving user adoption and satisfaction across the product suite, incorporating usability testing and developer feedback into each iteration.

AI Design Reviewer [Contract]
Mercor *Aug 2026—present, Contract · Remote*

- Promoted from Design Expert within my first week.
- Reviewed AI generated UX and UI work and other designers' submissions against quality standards and project guidelines.
- Delivered clear written feedback that helped contributors strengthen their work for AI design training.

AI Trainer & AI Quality Specialist
Invisible Technologies *Dec 2025—May 2026, Contract · Remote*

- Rated and annotated AI-generated outputs across text, image, and multimodal tasks against structured quality guidelines, flagging errors and inconsistencies before they reached production.
- Brought a product design perspective to the review process, surfacing usability and tone issues that purely technical accuracy checks would miss, and helping shape more user-centered AI behavior.

Founder & Product Lead
AB Trading - Construction Trading Company *Apr 2018—Jun 2025 Beirut, Lebanon*

- Founded and scaled a B2B/B2C operation from zero, leading a team of 15, managing 100+ client accounts, and holding full ownership of product decisions, vendor relationships, logistics, and P&L across 7 years.
- Applied a product mindset throughout the business, mapping customer journeys, identifying friction in ordering and fulfilment workflows driving 35% increase in customer activation.

Interior Designer
Fabraca Studios *Jan 2018—Sep 2023 Beirut, Lebanon*

- Led client-facing design projects from discovery through final execution.
- Applied user-centered thinking to spatial layouts, mapping how people would move through and experience each space.

SELECTED PROJECTS

RBC Mobile Banking UX Redesign
Fintech Product Improvement

- Identified a real friction point in RBC's mobile app: users had to manually calculate their running balance after each transaction, making it hard to trust the numbers they were seeing.
- Conducted usability testing with 5 participants, then designed and prototyped a Running Balance feature that automatically shows the balance after every transaction, with a toggle so users could turn it on or off.

StageUp
Learning Platform

- Designed end-to-end product for a career focused learning aggregator, syncing progress across Coursera, Udemy, LinkedIn Learning, and YouTube into one unified skill profile.
- Conducted usability testing with 5 participants across mid-fi and hi-fi prototypes, achieving a UMUX-LITE score of 88.33. Redesigned authentication flow and colour system to address accessibility failures against WCAG AA.

SKILLS

Design: Mixed methods user research, token based design systems, enterprise design thinking, WCAG 2.2 accessibility, stakeholder collaboration, usability testing, documentation.
Technical: Agentic Design Practices, Prompt Engineering, MCPs, Generative AI for UX Assets, Design MD, Claude code, Figma, FigJam, Webflow, Maze, cursor, Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator.
Languages: English (Fluent) · Arabic (Native)